

Salmo salar

Atlantic salmon



Length Up to 5 ft (1.5 m)

Weight Up to 99 lb (45 kg)

Sex Male/Female

Status Least concern

Location N.E. North America, W. and N. Europe, North Atlantic



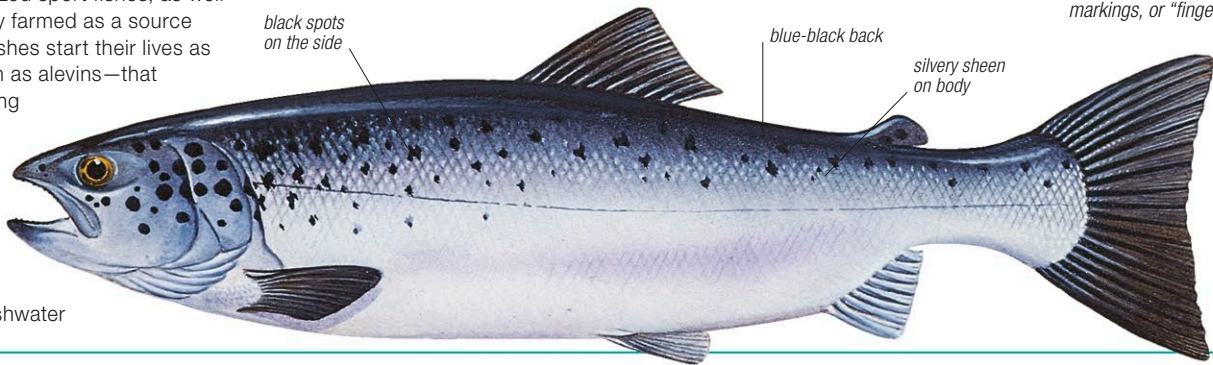
The Atlantic salmon is one of the world's most highly prized sport fishes, as well as being widely farmed as a source of food. Wild fishes start their lives as tiny fry—known as alevins—that hatch out among streambed gravel. The fry feed on a diet of insect larvae and other small animals, and after a freshwater

life of between 1 and 4 years, they begin their downstream migration to the sea. On entering saltwater, they lose their dark color and develop a silvery sheen, and for up to 4 years they roam widely throughout the North Atlantic, preying on other fishes. At the end of this period, they begin to become sexually mature, and make their way back to the rivers and streams where they originally hatched. Like other salmon, they are powerful swimmers, able to leap over almost all obstacles in their way. They rarely feed on their upstream journey, and by the time they

arrive at their spawning grounds, the females are plump with eggs, and the males have developed distinctively hooked jaws. The females are known to use their tails to excavate hollows in gravel, and the males lie alongside while the females lay eggs. Adult Atlantic salmon may die after spawning but, unlike other salmon, a large number of the adults often survive. Emaciated and exhausted, these fishes make their way back to the sea, where they feed and recover. They return to breed again at intervals of one or 2 years.



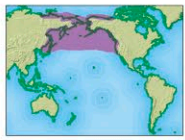
EARLY DAYS
At the age of a few months, young Atlantic salmon are known as parr. At this stage, they are about 6 in (15 cm) long and have distinctive dark markings, or “fingerprints,” along their backs.



READY TO BREED
When they reenter rivers, Atlantic salmon are silvery, with blue-black backs and black spots along their sides. Their powerful tails enable them to leap up waterfalls and weirs on their way to their breeding grounds.

Oncorhynchus gorbuscha

Pink salmon



Length Up to 30 in (76 cm)

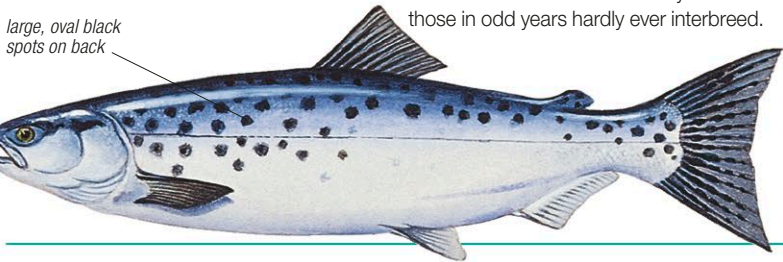
Weight Up to 14 lb (6.5 kg)

Sex Male/Female

Status Not evaluated

Location N.E. Asia, North Pacific, W. North America

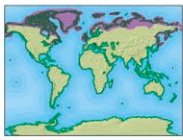




Of all salmon, this species spends the least time in fresh water and as soon as they hatch, the fry swim downstream and into coastal waters. Spawning adults may breed in coastal streams up to 620 miles (1,000 km) from the place they were born. Normally metallic blue, with the approach of the breeding season, it becomes olive-green or yellow, with a distinct red or pink tinge along the sides. The male also develops a high humped back and a hook at the end of the upper jaw. The pink salmon has a lifespan of 2 years, which means that fishes born in even years and those in odd years hardly ever interbreed.

Salvelinus alpinus

Arctic char



Length Up to 38 in (96 cm)

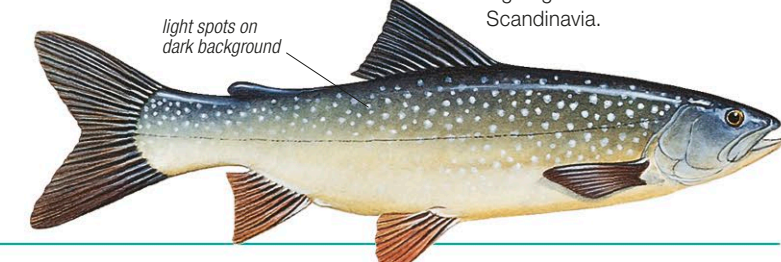
Weight Up to 26 lb (12 kg)

Sex Male/Female

Status Least concern

Location N. North America, N. Europe, N. Asia, Arctic Ocean

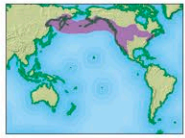




The Arctic char is the most northerly of all freshwater fishes. It is found in lakes in the Arctic tundra, where it spawns during autumn, as well as in mountains farther south, where spawning takes place in winter. Its color varies according to its breeding habits: adults that migrate toward the sea become brightly colored during the breeding season, but landlocked specimens, usually found in lakes, often have bright undersides all year round. The Arctic char is a popular sport fish among anglers in Canada and Scandinavia.

Oncorhynchus mykiss

Rainbow trout



Length Up to 4 ft (1.2 m)

Weight Up to 52 lb (24 kg)

Sex Male/Female

Status Not evaluated

Location N.E. Asia, North Pacific, North America



This black-spotted member of the salmon family is one of the world's most widely introduced freshwater fishes. Originally from rivers and lakes west of the Rocky Mountains, it has been spread eastward in North America, and to countries as far apart as the British Isles and New Zealand, wherever well-oxygenated, cool water can be found. Like all its relatives, the

rainbow trout is a predator, feeding on insects, snails, and crustaceans, and—when adult—on other fishes. It takes most of its food from the bottom, but also rises to the surface for flying insects—a habit exploited by anglers using artificial flies. Introduced rainbow trout often spend their entire lives in fresh water, but in their natural habitat, some adults spend part of their time at sea, returning to rivers to spawn. Compared to freshwater rainbow trout, these migratory adults—called “steelheads” in North America—grow faster, live longer, and are more productive.

RAINBOW COLORS
Freshwater forms of rainbow trout range from bluish green to brown on the back and sides, and are white or yellowish on the belly. Spawning males develop a vivid red or pink band on the sides.



In many parts of the temperate world, rainbow trout are raised in captivity. Some trout “farms” supply fishes for food but an increasing number raise this trout—a popular sport fish—for angling, using them to stock lakes where they can be caught by line. Farmed trout are fed on protein-rich pelleted food, and grow much more rapidly than they would in the wild.



TROUT FARMING